

~~HH 5~~

the Dearborn business files but remained in the permanent custodies of Sorenson and Ford.

~~W/At~~ "Naturally," Dollfus wrote, "the advantages that we have are because we belong to the Ford family, but advantages which we cannot overestimate under the present circumstances."

That Mr. Ford ^{too,} believe^d it a family matter ~~and~~ was shown by an increasingly warmer attachment to Mr. Dollfus. On October 10, he cabled:

"DELIGHTED TO HEAR YOU ARE MAKING PROGRESS. YOUR LETTERS MOST INTERESTING. FULLY
REALIZE GREAT HANDICAP YOU ARE WORKING UNDER. HOPE YOU AND FAMILY WELL. REGARDS.

EDSEL FORD"

Trouble soon developed of such serious proportions that a Mr. Lesto hired by Dollfus, became a courier between the two Dearborn executives and their diplomat-without-portfolio. Lesto brought news that the two "commissars" had developed a plan "to create a Ford organization, including Denmark, Holland, Belgium and possibly France, under the Cologne organization." The reason given by the "commissars" had been "the vital necessity for the German Army to receive vehicles of all kinds." Strangely, ^{M. Dollfus} ~~Mr. Albert~~ feared the power of the Cologne organization ^{headed by Krawinkel} more than he feared the Reich government, and his chief political anxiety apparently was ~~that~~ that any reorientation of European Ford interests in Germany would expose how the Ford plants were producing for the war machine.

"What the future organization of the Ford companies should be in Europe after Europe is re-made, is a matter for 'Ford' to decide, and not for Dr. Albert or Mr. Schmidt...